

PARAKH — Stage 3 PRD

Semantic Layer & Peer Cell Formation

1. Objective

Build a system that transforms raw records into **meaningful comparison groups (peer cells)**.

Each record must be assigned to a **peer cell**:

\$\$

(k, s)

\$\$

Where:

- (k): semantic cluster (type of work)
- (s): cost stratum (scale of work)

These peer cells are the **foundation for all downstream anomaly detection**.

2. Scope

Included

- Text embedding of `work_name`
- Semantic clustering
- Cost stratification
- Peer cell assignment
- Duplicate candidate detection (pairwise scoring)

Excluded

- Risk scoring
 - Confidence scoring (already done)
 - Entity graph construction
-

3. Inputs

From Stage 1:

Corpus.records

From Stage 2:

ConfidenceResult (optional for filtering low-C records)

4. Outputs

Each record must include:

```
{
  "cluster_id": int,      # k
  "cost_stratum": int,    # s
  "peer_cell": (k, s),
  "embedding": vector,
  "duplicate_score": float
}
```

5. Semantic Embedding

5.1 Input Field

- `work_name` (primary)
- optionally concatenate:
 - `implementing_agency`
 - `district`

5.2 Embedding Model

Use:

- Sentence transformer (multilingual)

Examples:

- `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` (fast baseline)
- multilingual model preferred (code-mixed data)

5.3 Preprocessing

Before embedding:

- lowercase
- remove punctuation

- normalize whitespace
 - remove boilerplate words:
 - "construction of"
 - "development of"
-

5.4 Output

```
embedding.shape = (d,)    # e.g., d = 384 or 768
```

6. Clustering (Semantic Groups)

6.1 Algorithm

Use:

```
HDBSCAN
```

Reason:

- No need to predefine number of clusters
 - Handles noise
 - Works with uneven cluster sizes
-

6.2 Parameters

- `min_cluster_size = 20`
 - `metric = cosine`
-

6.3 Output

Each record gets:

```
cluster_id = k
```

Noise points:

- Assign `cluster_id = -1`
 - Handle separately
-

6.4 Post-processing

- Remove clusters with size < threshold
 - Merge very small clusters into nearest large cluster
-

7. Cost Stratification

7.1 Input

- `sanction_amount`
-

7.2 Transformation

\$\$

$$x = \log(a + 1)$$

\$\$

7.3 Stratification

Option A (recommended):

- Quantile bins (e.g., 5 bins)

Option B:

- Fixed log-scale buckets
-

7.4 Output

```
cost_stratum = s
```

8. Peer Cell Formation

Each record:

```
peer_cell = (cluster_id, cost_stratum)
```

8.1 Minimum Cell Size

If:

```
len(cell) < n_min
```

Then:

- mark as **unstable**
- exclude from downstream scoring

Default:

```
n_min = 15
```

9. Duplicate Detection (Candidate Scoring)

9.1 Pairwise Score

\$\$
$$D(i,j) = \cos(e_i, e_j) \cdot \mathbb{1}[d_i = d_j] \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{|t_i - t_j|}{\tau_d}\right)$$

\$\$

9.2 Parameters

- ($\tau_d = 180$) days
-

9.3 Efficient Computation

Avoid ($O(N^2)$):

- Only compare within:
 - same district
 - same cluster
-

9.4 Per-record Score

\$\$
$$D_{\{\max\}}(i) = \max_{j \neq i} D(i,j)$$

\$\$

9.5 Output

```
duplicate_score = D_max
```

10. Implementation Architecture

10.1 Modules

- `embedding.py`
- `clustering.py`
- `stratification.py`
- `peer_cells.py`
- `duplicate_detection.py`

10.2 Core Class

```
class SemanticLayer:  
    def fit_transform(self, corpus):  
        return SemanticResult
```

10.3 Output Object

```
class SemanticResult:  
    cluster_ids: List[int]  
    cost_strata: List[int]  
    peer_cells: List[Tuple]  
    embeddings: np.ndarray  
    duplicate_scores: List[float]
```

11. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

- 50k records processed in < 10 seconds

Memory

- Embeddings stored efficiently (float32)

Determinism

- Fix random seed for clustering
-

12. Validation & Testing

12.1 Cluster Quality

Check:

- similar work_names grouped together
 - unrelated works separated
-

12.2 Cell Distribution

```
print(cell_sizes.describe())
```

Ensure:

- no extreme imbalance
 - reasonable spread
-

12.3 Duplicate Sanity Check

- identical names → high score
 - unrelated → low score
-

13. Edge Cases (MANDATORY)

Handle:

- Empty or short work_name
 - All records same text
 - Extremely skewed cost distribution
 - Single cluster output
 - All noise from HDBSCAN
-

14. Acceptance Criteria

Stage complete if:

- ☐ Every record has cluster_id
 - ☐ Cost strata assigned
-

- ☐ Peer cells formed
 - ☐ Duplicate scores computed
 - ☐ Small cells handled correctly
-

15. Definition of Done

- Records grouped into meaningful peer cells
 - Ready for Stage 4 (Risk Signals)
-

16. Key Design Principle

Compare like with like.

Anomaly detection without proper peer grouping is mathematically invalid.

This stage ensures:

- roads compared to roads
- small works compared to small works

—not everything against everything.
